

liberte, Egalite, Fraternite!
Vive la revolution!

classmate

Date _____
Page _____

The Political Sciences:-

What is Politics?

The ~~an~~ system / form of governing society? The way in which decisions are made and power is handled in society. The interplay b/w the diff ^{actors} in society.

Aristotle is Father of political science.

↳ Ethical activity concerned with creating a just society

↳ Humans are political animals

↳ We always disagree with each other. (naturally)

BJ does a lot of politics (~~Ex~~ Section 4 joke 25)

↳ Politics is the method to reach consensus b/w each other.

↳ Activity done to achieve consensus, requirement for a good life

Politics decides what we get & what we don't.

Humans are political animals.

Politics is the activity through which people make, preserve & amend the general rules under which they live. Linked with the concepts of conflict & cooperations.

The defn is essential contested

To do something to influence decisions is force.

To influence without doing anything is power.

Politics as the art of Government:-

Authoritative allocation of values.

Inputs are demands

Outputs are laws, programs, taxes, benefits, adjudication & enforcement.

Also the rejection of demands.

Outputs influence future inputs-

Power tends to corrupt, absolute power corrupts absolutely

↳ Due to presence of having to acquire and maintain power.

Politics as Public Affairs → political

The distinction b/w public & private affairs.

Essentially State intervention is only in the public affairs of life.

The distinction is dependent on time, the society, etc

The outcome is security for us ~~and~~ in the contract b/w us and the State

The State defines what is public & what is not.

Politics as Compromise and Consensus:-

The way in which decisions are made.

Method of resolving conflict, by compromise, conciliation and negotiation, rather than through force and naked power.

Politics as Power

Decision Making ; Agenda Setting ; Thought Control

↓

↓

↓

Ability to influence content of decisions

The usage of force (stick), productive exchanges (deal), creation of loyalty (bribe)

Control of political agenda, thereby preventing issues or proposals from being aired in the first place

Lobbying

Ability to influence

another by shaping what they think, want, or needs

Ideological indoctrination or psychological control.

Ads & Propaganda

Theoretical & Applied Politics

Theory of the State vs The State
 " " + Government vs The Government
 " " " Legislation vs The Law & The Legislation
 " " " State as an artificial person vs The State Personified

Approaches to the Study of Politics:-

Philosophical Tradition:- Occupation with essential ethical or normative questions
Performs Value Judgements

Empirical Tradition:- Based on observation & experience
Does not perform Value Judgements

Should students of politics seek to be objective and politically neutral.

Politics is not merely the choice b/w right and wrong

Defining the State

Territory, Population, Govt, Sovereignty

Political institution establishing sovereign jurisdiction within defined territorial ~~body~~ borders and exercises authority through a set of permanent institutions

↳ public responsible for collective organisation, funded at public's expense

Nation State = State with a unifying culture / cultural concepts

state = govt. institutions + courts + nationalised industries + social security system & body politic

Origin of State:-

- (i) **Divine Right**:- Rulers chosen by divine providence, wield unchallengeable authority and a defence for monarchial absolutism.
- (ii) **Social Contract Theory**:- Voluntary agreement b/w individuals through which an organised society or state is brought into existence.
Exchange of a share of profit for guarantee of security etc.

Role of the State:-

- (i) **Minimal State**:- Protective body, citizens are bound of basic framework of peace and social order. *USA perhaps*
- (ii) **Developmental State**:- Intervenes in economic life to induce development & growth.
- (iii) **Social Democratic State**:- Broader social restructuring, intervene for social equality, fairness & justice. State is an economic actor.
- (iv) **Collectivised State**:- Economic life is under state control.
- (v) **Totalitarian State**:- Influences all aspects of life of its citizens.

Government:-

It takes collective decisions and implement them.

Legislation, Execution & Adjudication

↳ Monarchy: Absolute & Constitutional

↳ Democracy

↳ Parliamentary: Executive is responsible / answerable to the legislature

↳ Presidential: No answerability

↳ Communism

- ↳ Aristocracy
- ↳ Oligarchy
- ↳ Military Dictatorship
- ↳ Theocracy
- ↳ Totalitarianism
- ↳ Colonialism

Liberty:-

The notion of choice, and the absence of constraints to make and exercise such a choice. There is also the existence of conditions that enable us to choose:

- ve liberty & state must stay out
- ve liberty & state must intervene to ensure liberty proactively

Justice:-

Giving each person what is due to them.

Procedural Justice & fair procedures (making and applying rules, innocent until proven guilty) Well defined process to make law.

Substantive Justice & scenario based elements of justice. Are the rules just or unjust.

Justice for one might be injustice to the other.

Constitution does not provide for S. Justice in India

Equality:- Not blanket uniformity. Levelling conditions crucial to human well-being. These differ b/w places, societies, etc.

On any criteria, providing to those who have less is equality, but providing to those who are well off is a violation of equality. Law should treat every individual equally, regardless of socio-economic conditions.

Justice should be blind to all other factors than those relevant to the court.

Types of Equalities:-

↳ Eq. of Opportunity

↳ Eq. of Outcome

↳ Eq. of Welfare

↳ Eq. of Resources

↳ Eq. of Capabilities ← Capability is the ability to achieve a certain sort of fn.

India follows Equality of Opportunity.

Rights:- RT that which is due to an individual

-ve rights:- Rights that require non-interference from the society and the State. Right to Property for example.

+ve rights:- Rights that impose obligations on the society or the state for the fuller enjoyment of that right. For example Right to Health

Human Rights:-

Security

Liberty

Political

Due Process

Equality

Welfare

Democracy:-

Basic assumption: Everyone is equal & rational

Based on political community.

Everyone gets to decide and are capable of electing their representatives

Three basic questions that need answering -

- 1) Who are the people?
- 2) How should the people rule? [Picking the electoral system]
- 3) How far should the rule extend?

Citizenship :- legal relationship b/w the state & the citizen

- ↳ legal status ← dependent on the rights received & right to claim his protection
- ↳ political agency ← dependent on the ability to participate in political processes
- ↳ source of identity

Power :- Getting someone to do something that they otherwise would not have done.

Sovereign ← President of India will also be elected. No other body can interfere in the decision making of India.

Socialist & Secular (Added later, but provision existed ab initio)

- ↳ State & religion do not co-interfere. (Two wheels theory)
- ↳ In India, this means that state does not discriminate b/w religions, but state can interfere.

Democratic Republic ← P. President is elected

Justice ← Social, economic & political

Liberty ← Thought, expression, belief, faith and worship

Equality ← Status & Opportunity

Fraternity ← dignity of the individual & the unity & integrity of the nation.

Unitary List, State List, Concurrent List

↳ Union Law gets precedence in case of conflicts

Balance of Power :- System of checks & balances.

If parliament creates a law that contradicts the constitution, the Supreme Court can strike it down. And if the SC starts overreaching for power, then the legislature can try impeaching the justices.

Fundamental Right disallowing can be taken straight to the SC.

Primary role of SC is to uphold the Constitution.
The Secondary role is to handle conflicts b/w states.
Tertiary role is to handle issues flowing up from lower courts.

Rajya Sabha is called the Upper House since it represents the ideals of the states (MLAs) & UTs.